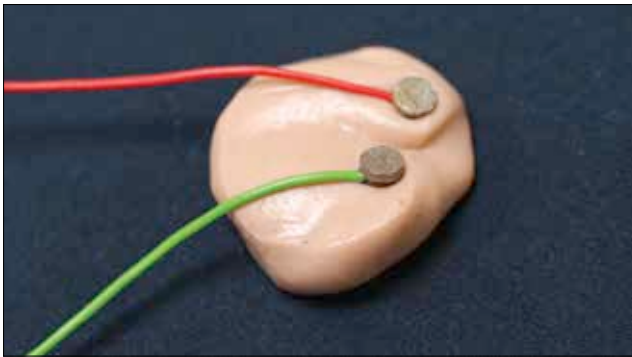


SHOWCASE

Vagus earbuds

Language translating earbuds have been a thing for a while now. They're capable of translating languages in real-time. Now, things are moving a step forward, with earbuds that could actually potentially help you learn new languages as well.

Researchers have reportedly been working on such a device for years now, which work by stimulating the major nerve leading up to the wearer's brain. The key is learning how the brain processes speech and languages. Matthew Leonard, a cognitive neuroscientist at the University of California, has



explored documented use of direct brain stimulation in neurosurgery patients to better understand the function of specific brain regions. This is what led to the experiment above, a device to help learners acquire the sounds of languages, unfamiliar to them. While it certainly sounds like it's from the realms of science-fiction, there's definitely real science at play here.

The tech is still far from being commercially available, but it's still cool to know that such stuff is in the works.



PinePhone

The PinePhone is a phone created by Pine64. They're not very well known in the mobile space, and they've been selling ARM-based products since 2015. The first versions of the phone went on sale earlier this year, and Pine64 have already created different community versions of the phone, with different distributions of Linux on them. That's what makes the PinePhone interesting, they're phones built to run on Linux.

One of the features unique to the PinePhone is the presence of a hardware killswitches, underneath the the back of the case. These switches, six of them to be exact, each control the modem, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, mic, rear camera, front camera and the headphone jack. With these switches, you can physically disable specific components, ensuring absolute control in the users hands. Afraid of someone listening in on your conversations? Disable the mic. Afraid of being spied on through your camera? Turn it off. Want to know what it's like to own an incredibly expensive phone? Turn off the headphone jack.

Of course, then there's the fact that you have versions that run on Linux. This gives you more control over the software on the phone as well, allowing you to turn off features such as GPS, accelerometers, and compasses. Like, for sure.

Knowing that you have complete control over your device is definitely a great feeling.

Quick Charge 5.0

It's been a little more than three years since we saw Quick Charge 4+ from Qualcomm. Now, they've come out with Quick Charge 5.0. The next generation fast-charging, capable of charging your phone within minutes. The new standard is expected to be included with smartphones in the coming few months.

So what does Quick Charge 5 have over its predecessor? For one, it's the first charging standard to support 100 watts of power for smartphones. What does that mean? Well, if you have



5 a Quick Charge 5 compatible phone, you can charge it from 0 to 50 in merely five minutes. And from 0 to 100 in just 15. That's totally unprecedented.

According to Qualcomm, the new standard is a whopping 70 percent faster than the previous standard. It also delivers 10 times more power than Quick Charge 1. While remaining 10 degrees cooler than Quick Charge 4. The new standard will be supported by Snapdragon 865 and Snapdragon 865 Plus, but the tech still needs to be implemented.